

RICHARD OSUNGU

MEAL, Research & Evidence Specialist | Data Analytics | Programme Quality & Learning

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

MEAL, quantitative and qualitative analysis, and data science professional with over 7 years of progressive experience across humanitarian, public health, livelihoods and community development programmes in Kenya. Currently serving as a MEAL Manager, providing strategic leadership in the design, operationalization and continuous strengthening of monitoring, evaluation and learning systems for complex, multi-donor portfolios.

Experienced in establishing and managing programme monitoring systems including theory of change, logical and results frameworks, indicator performance tracking table, digital data collection and information systems, data verification and quality assurance, field monitoring, performance tracking, analysis and reporting. Currently responsible for monitoring Global Fund-supported malaria interventions spanning 528 Community Health Units, alongside mental health, disability inclusion and basic needs programming.

Strong technical expertise in data management and analysis using KHIS, eCHIS, Kobo Toolbox, ODK, ONA, Advanced Excel, SPSS, STATA, Python and NVivo, with experience developing Power BI and Looker Studio dashboards that translate routine monitoring, survey and field-assessment data into actionable insights.

Demonstrated experience in mixed-methods research, implementation research, learning and adaptive programming, including KIIs, FGDs, thematic analysis, baseline and endline assessments, DQAs and routine performance monitoring. Experienced in translating complex evidence into donor reports, analytical briefs, presentations, lessons learned and knowledge products, while strengthening the capacity of programme and MEAL teams.

Committed to ethical data collection, confidentiality, accountability to affected populations, disability inclusion and responsible use of evidence, with a strong awareness of safeguarding and PSEAH principles in programme monitoring.

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- Lead MEAL oversight for Global Fund-supported malaria interventions covering 528 Community Health Units in Kakamega and Kisii Counties.
- Lead monitoring and research coordination for an 11-month digital-health implementation study evaluating an AI-enabled mRDT reader integrated with eCHIS.
- Led development of the Theory of Change for Practical Action's Circular Economy for Household Organic Waste (CE4HOW) project in Kakamega.
- Delivered an end-to-end humanitarian research consultancy for Kaalmo Relief & Development in Dollow, Somalia, spanning questionnaire design, a 393-household baseline and a 250-household PDM, supported by FGDs and KIIs.
- Conducted quarterly DQAs for a government/IFAD aquaculture programme, contributing to a 30% reduction in data discrepancies.

CORE COMPETENCIES

MEAL Systems & Programme Quality: MEL Systems Design, Strengthening & Operationalization; Results-Based Management (RBM); Project Cycle Management (PCM); Monitoring Frameworks; Theory of Change (ToC); Logframes; Indicator Tracking and Performance Tables (ITTs/IPTTs); Programme Performance Monitoring & Reporting; Field Monitoring, Verification & Supportive Supervision; Accountability to Affected Populations (AAP); Community Feedback; Programme Responsiveness

Research & Evaluation: Research, Assessments & Programme Evaluation; Baseline and Endline Assessments; Needs Assessments; Post-Distribution Monitoring (PDM); Mixed-Methods Research; Implementation Research; Quantitative & Qualitative Data Analysis; Sampling; Key Informant Interviews (KIIs); Focus Group Discussions (FGDs)

Data, Digital Systems & Information Management: Data Management, Verification & Validation; Data Quality Assessments (DQA) & Quality Assurance; Digital Monitoring Systems; Management Information Systems (MIS); Mobile

Data Collection; Data Visualization & Dashboard Development; Data Protection; Confidentiality; Safeguarding; Responsible and Responsive Data Management

Learning, Reporting & Leadership: Evidence Generation; Research Uptake & Decision-Support Products; Learning, Knowledge Management & Adaptive Programming; Donor Reporting & Compliance; Evidence Translation; Partner & Stakeholder Coordination; Capacity Building, Training, Coaching & Mentorship; Humanitarian, Public Health, Livelihoods, Agriculture and Community Development Programming

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Data analysis: Advanced Excel, SPSS, STATA, Python, SQL and NVivo

Business intelligence and visualization: Power BI, Looker Studio and Matplotlib

Digital data collection: Kobo Toolbox, ODK, ONA and XLSForm-based tool design

Information systems: KHIS/DHIS2, eCHIS and CPIMS

Spatial analysis: QGIS

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

TINADA Youth Action Africa - MEAL Manager

April 2025 - Present | Kenya

- Design and operationalize comprehensive MEAL systems, monitoring frameworks, logframes, indicator tracking tables (ITTs/IPTTs), data-collection tools and reporting processes across a multi-donor portfolio covering malaria, mental health, disability inclusion and basic-needs programming.
- Lead monitoring of Global Fund-supported malaria interventions across 528 Community Health Units, ensuring alignment with donor frameworks and national health-reporting standards.
- Lead data verification, validation, Data Quality Assessments (DQAs) and quality assurance across programme datasets, supporting accurate, complete, timely and disaggregated programme, donor and national reporting.
- Develop Power BI and Looker Studio dashboards and analytical reports that translate routine monitoring, surveys and field assessments into management insights.
- Lead monitoring and research coordination for an 11-month study of an AI-enabled mRDT reader integrated into eCHIS, generating evidence on diagnostic accuracy, health-worker adoption, cost-effectiveness and service-delivery performance.
- Oversee MEAL for the Bridge Beyond Barriers and Basic Needs projects, tracking logframe indicators and integrating disability inclusion and mental health considerations.
- Supervise and mentor 2 MEAL Officers, 25 coaches and 20 peer educators on data tools, quality-assurance protocols and production of accurate, disaggregated datasets.
- Translate evidence into donor reports, analytical briefs, presentations, lessons learned and actionable recommendations for management, donors, government and partners, while strengthening accountability to affected populations (AAP), community feedback and programme-responsiveness mechanisms.

Secours Islamique France (SIF) - Part-time MEAL Officer

January 2025 - December 2025

- Performed descriptive and comparative statistical analysis of baseline, endline and post-distribution monitoring datasets to measure progress and assess programme effectiveness.
- Conducted thematic analysis of community perceptions and triangulated qualitative and quantitative findings to support programme adaptation.
- Supported rapid needs assessments and mixed-methods research, including survey tools, structured interview guides and FGD discussion themes.
- Produced and disseminated five lessons-learned and best-practice products for internal and external stakeholders.

Kaalmo Relief & Development (KRD) - Independent Research & MEAL Consultant - Somalia Flood Response and Recovery Project

February 2025 - May 2025 | Dollow area, Somalia

- Led the assignment across the full research and MEAL cycle, including methodology development, questionnaire and assessment-tool formulation, baseline assessment, data management, mixed-methods analysis, post-distribution monitoring and reporting.

- Designed and implemented a mixed-methods baseline covering 393 households, 8 FGDs with 64 participants and 8 KIIs across eight flood-affected communities.
- Assessed displacement, livelihoods, food security, WASH, health, safety, protection and humanitarian needs, including the experiences of internally displaced and other vulnerable households.
- Designed and conducted PDM with 250 beneficiary households, FGDs and KIIs across five project locations, evaluating food vouchers, livestock support, water trucking, hygiene kits and non-food items.
- Integrated quantitative analysis with qualitative triangulation to assess recovery, income and livelihoods, food security, health, protection, beneficiary satisfaction and remaining needs.
- Produced comprehensive baseline and PDM reports with findings, lessons learned and practical recommendations for recovery programming, livelihoods, accountability to affected populations, monitoring and future humanitarian interventions.

Practical Action Kenya - Temporary MEL Assistant

July 2024 - October 2024 | Kenya

- Led development of the Theory of Change for the Circular Economy for Household Organic Waste (CE4HOW) project in Kakamega, mapping interventions, outputs, outcomes, impact pathways and critical assumptions.
- Linked the CE4HOW results pathway to measurable indicators and the MEL framework, enabling the team to test assumptions, monitor progress and adapt implementation using evidence.
- Oversaw deployment and quality management of ONA and Kobo Toolbox data-collection tools, improving data accuracy, completeness and operational efficiency.
- Designed and facilitated 15 capacity-building sessions for field teams on MEL practice, data standards and donor-reporting compliance.
- Performed quantitative trend analysis of programme indicators and conducted qualitative field assessments on youth engagement in the Resilient Agriculture project.
- Documented lessons learned and contributed to knowledge management and evidence-based reporting.

State Department for Fisheries, Aquaculture and the Blue Economy - ABDP - MEAL Officer

November 2020 - April 2024 | Kenya

- Developed and managed M&E frameworks supporting evidence-based decision-making in aquaculture development programmes.
- Conducted quarterly data quality audits, reducing discrepancies by 30% and strengthening baseline, mid-term and end-term evaluation data.
- Led cross-functional data-governance activities aligning programme outcomes with KPIs and national reporting standards.
- Conducted qualitative evaluations of smallholder farmers' experiences, technology adoption and value-chain challenges to inform programme adjustments.
- Produced three case studies and success stories to strengthen stakeholder learning and knowledge sharing.

Women Fighting AIDS in Kenya (WOFAK) - Monitoring & Evaluation Assistant / Case Manager

September 2017 - September 2020 | Kenya

- Integrated the Child Protection Information Management System for real-time tracking of vulnerable children, strengthening accountability and case management.
- Facilitated M&E training for programme officers and strengthened field data collection, monitoring methodology and accountability practices.
- Conducted interviews with caregivers, children and stakeholders to assess HIV/AIDS interventions and identify service-delivery gaps.
- Analysed case-management reports, generated recommendations and documented best practices and learning for donor reporting and programme improvement.

SELECTED RESEARCH, EVALUATION & KNOWLEDGE PRODUCTS

Medic Afya | TINADA Youth Action Africa - Implementation Research - Malaria and Digital Health Evaluation

2025 - 2026 | Kenya

- Research focus: integration of the HealthPulse AI-enabled mRDT reader with eCHIS and its effects on diagnostic accuracy, health-worker adoption, treatment decision-making, cost-effectiveness and service delivery.

- Lead MEL and research coordination and support translation of mixed-methods findings into briefs, presentations, progress updates and recommendations for potential scale-up.

Practical Action Kenya - Theory of Change - Circular Economy for Household Organic Waste (CE4HOW)

2024 | Kakamega, Kenya

- Led development of a causal results pathway connecting household waste segregation, informal waste-worker strengthening, organic-waste collection and processing, farmer access to organic fertilizer, and policy and market advocacy to environmental, livelihood and sustainability outcomes.
- Identified key assumptions and connected expected changes to measurable results and indicators for ongoing learning and adaptive management.

Government of Kenya & IFAD - Aquaculture Value Chain Study and Blue Book Development

January 2021 - June 2021 | Kenya

- Collaborated with government stakeholders on a national study mapping aquaculture stakeholders and value-chain actors.
- Analysed sector evidence to support programme planning, resource allocation and national strategy; findings contributed to an Aquaculture Blue Book adopted as a public planning resource.

EDUCATION

University of East London - Master of Science in Data Science

2026 - Present | Ongoing

Meru University of Science and Technology - Bachelor of Science in Mathematics and Computer Science

2019

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL TRAINING

- Project Management Essentials - DisasterReady.org, 2026
- Data Science for Monitoring and Evaluation - Humanitarian Data Science Academy, 2024
- Artificial Intelligence Essentials - ALX Africa, 2024
- Certificate in Monitoring and Evaluation - Mount Kenya University, 2020
- Fundraising and Mobilization of Resources - Kenya Community Development Fund, 2019

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

- East Africa Public Leadership Programme – currently ongoing (<https://www.futurelect.org/>)
- Chairperson, Nyakach University Students Association - mobilized resources and led community development initiatives.
- Tree Planting Initiative, Nyakach Constituency - led a community environmental conservation and resilience initiative.
- Youth Sports Tournament, Nyakach - organized a community initiative to identify and nurture youth talent.

REFERENCES

Available upon request.